

Language Choices

Originally, we were going to use HTML, CSS and PHP only for the development. This is because they are the languages that our team are learning for our course this year. Therefore, we have the most experience in them and thought it produces the best product for this reason. If we were given a longer timeframe maybe it would have been worth going for JS over PHP however it would be unreasonable to get the whole team to learn it to a good standard in the timeframe. Although we did end up using a minimal amount of some simple JS to create some functionality that PHP would have greatly overcomplicated.

JS was used as a backup for features that weren't easily implemented in PHP.

Homepage Front End

The first thing we developed was the design of the front end of the website. This was solely the HTML and CSS of the website, none of the buttons or interaction functions. This gives a good base to build the rest of the site off, as parts of the site such as the navbar and the CSS styling can be reused. It also makes it obvious what functionality needs to be implemented as the user would expect when using the site.

Was able to implement extra features to the front-end that weren't in the design, this was solely done by just implementing extra things that team members thought of during development.

However, the front-end does not zoom in as well as we would like, the text and images get a bit misplaced when zoomed in excessively.

Button Functionality

Next, we used JS to make the copy link button work and allow for the link to a specific segment of the page to be copied and then shared with friends or on social media. We also added functionality to the download PDF button, allowing for you to download a test document with information on T levels.

We had problems implementing functionality for the copy link button using PHP, in the end we did figure out how we could do it. However, we thought it was an overcomplicated way, so decided to use JS to make it simpler.

UI for other pages

Created the front-end UI for the login, registration and newsletter page. Made sure to style all the inputs properly so it all looks finished.

Development

Set up the back-end code for the website. This involved creating and linking a database to the code. Then adding to the database from the newsletter and signup form. Also made sure the login properly checks the databases password. Also made sure the dropdown boxes get the school names from the database.

Chatbot

Implemented a fixed div in the bottom right of the page to have a chatbot in it for the AI prototype. Then made most of it except the top be hidden until clicked(opened) by the user. Then once open it allows the user to enter a message and ask the "AI". It then adds it to the chat history what you messaged, and then in blue the "AI's" response. Currently the AI has a fixed response that doesn't change, as it would be incredibly difficult to implement a proper AI in the timeframe.

Secret Page

Used PHP to automatically redirect people who are not logged in away from the private web page. This web page will only be sent to the user's device if they are logged in, therefore preventing anyone without access from viewing anything on it.

Move navbar and ai

Put them in a separate file that can be imported to every page, this avoids repeating excessive amounts of code, by just being able to add it to every page with 1 line of code.

Random chatbot responses

Utilized random number generator, to pick a random response from a list of responses for the AI. This makes it more realistic as it isn't repeating the exact same thing. This did take longer than it should, as our team have a lack of experience in JS, so we had to spend about an hour researching random generation in JavaScript.

Login state

The user's login is saved using the session super global, this means that their login is saved for 5 minutes every time they move between pages, however if they stay on the same page or leave for 5 minutes, when they refresh, they will be logged out.